

SENATE No. 495**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

John C. Velis

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to codify the Hospital to Home Partnership Program.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>John C. Velis</i>	<i>Hampden and Hampshire</i>	
<i>Paul K. Frost</i>	<i>7th Worcester</i>	<i>1/29/2025</i>
<i>Susannah M. Whipps</i>	<i>2nd Franklin</i>	<i>2/3/2025</i>
<i>Joanne M. Comerford</i>	<i>Hampshire, Franklin and Worcester</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Jacob R. Oliveira</i>	<i>Hampden, Hampshire and Worcester</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>2/26/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>2/26/2025</i>
<i>Michael D. Brady</i>	<i>Second Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>2/28/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>3/21/2025</i>
<i>Brendan P. Crighton</i>	<i>Third Essex</i>	<i>3/26/2025</i>
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>4/3/2025</i>
<i>Sal N. DiDomenico</i>	<i>Middlesex and Suffolk</i>	<i>4/8/2025</i>
<i>Paul W. Mark</i>	<i>Berkshire, Hampden, Franklin and Hampshire</i>	<i>4/9/2025</i>
<i>John F. Keenan</i>	<i>Norfolk and Plymouth</i>	<i>4/23/2025</i>

SENATE No. 495

By Mr. Velis, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 495) of John C. Velis, Paul K. Frost, Susannah M. Whipps, Joanne M. Comerford and other members of the General Court for legislation to codify the Hospital to Home Partnership Program. Elder Affairs.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to codify the Hospital to Home Partnership Program.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 19A of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after section 4 the
2 following section:-

3 Section 4 ½. (a) There is hereby established within the executive office of health and
4 human services a Hospital to Home Partnership Program, with the mission to promote
5 partnerships between Acute Care Hospitals, as defined by section 25B of chapter 111 and Aging
6 Services Access Points (ASAPs), as defined by section 4B of chapter 19A and to strengthen
7 communication and coordination with community providers to promote institutional diversion
8 and increase discharge rates from hospitals to home and community-based settings.

9 (b) There will be within each participating Acute Care Hospital no less than 1 ASAP staff
10 serving as Home and Community Based Services (HCBS) Hospital Liaisons, with the designated
11 role to support the Hospital's efforts to connect individuals to HCBS programs and community

- 12 services to enable a community discharge instead of a skilled nursing facility or other
- 13 institutional placement